

YUE WANG

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(Latest version)

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Ph.D., Quantitative Marketing 2026 (expected)

M.Phil., Quantitative Marketing 2022

University of Rochester

M.Sc., Business Research, Information Systems 2020

University of Science and Technology of China

B.S., Statistics, *Gold Award (Top 1%)* 2018

Washington University in St. Louis

Exchange student 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive

Digital Platforms, Consumer Choice Dynamics, Media Influence

Methodological

Deep Learning for Graphs, Deep Generative Models, Causal Inference, Bayesian Estimation Methods, Natural Language Processing

HONORS AND AWARDS

Best Paper Award, Asia-Pacific Marketing Academy Annual Conference (APMA) 2025

Runner-up, HKUST Business School PhD Student Conference 2025

Fellow, ISMS Marketing Science Doctoral Consortium 2025

SBM Dean's PhD Fellowship, HKUST 2023–2024

Postgraduate Scholarship, HKUST 2020–2025

Simon Business School Doctoral Fellowship 2018–2020

UGC Research Travel Award×3, HKUST 2022–2025

Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, USTC 2018

Gold medal (Top 10 in China) in WorldQuant Challenge Alphathon 2017

WORKING PAPERS

Yue Wang, Yi Zhao, Ying Zhao, “Understanding Demand Structure in the Two-Sided Markets: A Network-Based Revenue Analysis Approach.”

– *Job Market Paper*

– *Best Paper Award*, Asia-Pacific Marketing Academy Annual Conference (APMA) 2025

Yue Wang, Ying Zhao, Yi Zhao, Yang Shi, “How News from Different Media Channels Shape Consumer Purchase: Causal Evidence from the Chinese Pharmaceutical Market.”

– Reject & Resubmit at *Marketing Science*

Yue Wang, Ying Zhao, Min Zhao, “Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Likes versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content.” *Preparing for submission*

Yue Wang, Xiaobei Shen, Xiabing Zheng, “Ride The Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising.” *Preparing for submission*

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Yue Wang, “When Comments Strike a Chord: How Timestamp Congruence Reshape Creator Content Design.”

Ziyuan Li, **Yue Wang**, Xiabing Zheng, “Empowering Financial Decisions: The Role of AI Chatbots in Preference Discovery.”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Understanding Demand Structure in the Two-Sided Markets: A Network Based Revenue Analysis Approach

ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2025

Washington DC

APMA Conference 2025

Shenzhen, Guangdong

How News from Different Media Channels Shape Consumer Purchase: Causal Evidence from the Chinese Pharmaceutical Market

ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2023

Miami FL

APMA Conference 2025

Shenzhen, Guangdong

Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Likes versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content

ACR Conference 2022

Denver CO

Ride The Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising

INFORMS Annual Meeting 2023

Phoenix AZ

PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Ele.me, Alibaba, Shanghai, China

Research Intern

Data & Algorithms Group, mentored by Dr. Zhe Li

Apr 2024–Apr 2025

Foster School of Business, University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Research Assistant

Information Systems Department, supervised by Prof. Yong Tan

Aug 2017–Sep 2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Interests

Machine Learning in Marketing, Digital Marketing, Marketing Analytics, Quantitative Marketing Research, Marketing Management, Retailing

Teaching Assistant

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Retailing (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2024

Marketing Management (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2023

Consumer Behavior (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2023

Consumer Behavior (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2022

Retailing (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2022

Marketing Analytics (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2021

University of Rochester

Intro to Business Analytics (*Graduate*)

Fall A 2019

Social Media Analytics (*Graduate*)

Fall B 2019

GRADUATE COURSEWORK

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

MARK 5410	Seminar in Quantitative Modeling	Ying Zhao
MARK 5420	Behavioral Decision Theory	A.V. Muthkrishnan
MARK 5520	Experimental Design and Analysis for Behavioral Research	Rongrong Zhou
MARK 6510	Current Topics in Consumer Research	Jiewen Hong
MARK 6900	Quantitative Marketing	Song Lin
MKT 8633	Empirical Marketing Research (<i>at CityU</i>)	Joseph Ryoo
ECON 5630	Empirical Industrial Organization	Kohei Kawaguchi
MIMT 5310	Understanding Consumers: A Strategic Approach	Amy N. Dalton
COMP 5214	Advanced Deep Learning Architectures (<i>audit</i>)	Qingfeng Chen

University of Rochester

AEC 511	Advanced Price Theory I	Michael Raith
AEC 513	Industrial Organization Theory	Greg Shaffer; Heikki Rantakari
AEC 514	Game Theory	Heikki Rantakari
AEC 520	Advanced Causal Inference/Machine Learning	Paul Ellickson
ECON 484	Math Statistics/Econometrics	Nese Yildiz
ECON 485	Intro to Econometrics I	Bin Chen
ECON 487	Research in Applied Econometrics	Ronni Pavan
MSM 504	Theory of Probability & Stochastic	Henri Groenevelt
MSM 505	Theory of Probability & Stochastic II	Phillip Lederer
MSM 511	Advanced Topics in CIS and OM	Yaron Shaposhnik; Huaxia Rui
MSM 522	Optimization	Phillip Lederer
CIS 417	Introduction to Business Analytics	Rajiv M. Dewan
CIS 432	Predictive Analysis/Python	Yaron Shaposhnik
CIS 511	Research Topics and Methods in Information Systems	Huaxia Rui

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming: R, Python, PyTorch, Fortran, Stata, SAS, SQL, C, Tableau, Matlab, Mathematica
Language: English (proficient), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Interests: Piano (Level 8), Latin Dance (Level 6), Folk Dance (Level 6), Musical Theory (Level 3), Snowboarding

REFERENCES

Ying Zhao (Advisor)

Associate Professor
Department of Marketing
School of Business and Management
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
Email: mkyzhao@ust.hk

Yi Zhao

Associate Professor
Department of Marketing
Robinson College of Business
Georgia State University
Email: yizhao@gsu.edu

Mengze Shi

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Department of Marketing
School of Business and Management
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
Email: mengzeshi@ust.hk

ABSTRACTS

“Understanding Demand Structure in the Two-Sided Markets: A Network-Based Revenue Analysis Approach.” with Yi Zhao, Ying Zhao (*Job Market Paper*)

A key decision for two-sided digital platforms involves the selection of sellers to host, as the right sellers offering suitable products are crucial for attracting and retaining customers, thereby driving revenue growth. Platforms typically assess sellers based on their revenue contributions, which are influenced by the market relationships among sellers and buyers. A unit-based approach to evaluate a seller's revenue contribution can lead to biased conclusions, as it does not account for the interdependence among sellers and buyers, where a seller's performance is influenced by both its own actions and its interactions within the platform's network. This paper proposes a network-based approach that captures the sellers' revenue contributions to the platform, considering the interdependence among sellers and buyers. The approach integrates multiple machine learning methods, including Variational Autoencoders (VAE), Graph Neural Networks (GNN), and Gated Recurrent Units (GRU). This allows us to analyze how the seller-seller, buyer-buyer and seller-buyer interconnectedness, as well as the evolution of these connections over time, affect a seller's revenue contribution to the platform. By applying this method to a major food delivery platform in China, we find that our proposed model that accounts for network effects outperforms the non-network-based models. Counterfactual experiments based on the estimated model provide insights into the platform's strategies for inviting new sellers and the strategies of sellers in product offerings.

“How News from Different Media Channels Shape Consumer Purchase: Causal Evidence from the Chinese Pharmaceutical Market.” with Ying Zhao, Yi Zhao, Yang Shi

(Reject & Resubmit at *Marketing Science*)

Inferring the causal impact of news on consumer preference is challenging due to potential endogeneity issues, such as omitted variable bias and reverse causality. We leverage the unique context of the pharmaceutical market in China during COVID-19, characterized by high intensity and variation in news coverage across time and media channels regarding the effectiveness of Chinese medicine in combating COVID-19, to make causal inferences about the differing impacts of news from various channels (TV, online news platforms and social media) on consumer preferences and purchasing behaviors in the pharmaceutical categories unrelated to COVID-19. During this period, a significant portion of news coverage is driven by external events related to research breakthroughs and clinical findings on the effectiveness of Chinese medicine. This provides strong instrumental variables that enable us to address endogeneity concerns in making causal inferences. Our findings suggest that the three media channels affect consumer purchases differently. The popularity of news about Chinese medicine from social media, irrespective of its sentiment, positively affects the sales of Chinese medicine. In contrast, both the popularity and positivity of news from online news platforms play a positive role. Further analysis suggests that these effects exhibit different interactive patterns with consumers' pre-existing preferences.

“Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Likes versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content.” with Ying Zhao, Min Zhao

Motivated by the challenge of content underprovision on social media platforms, the current work draws upon research on reciprocation and unpacking to examine the differentiating effect of feedback type (likes versus comments) and presentation format (packing versus unpacking) on user-generated content (UGC). Using field data from NetEase Cloud Music, the authors demonstrate empirically that comments from viewers are more effective than likes in motivating subsequent content generation, despite the greater number of likes. Addressing the natural confound in the field setting that comments are often viewed individually in an unpacked manner whereas likes are viewed in a packed format as a total number, the authors conducted two follow-up experiments to examine the effect of unpacking (i.e., displaying feedback as separate individual feedback). The results showed that holding feedback type and amount constant, presenting viewers' feedback in an unpacked format

increases creators' subsequent content generation because of the increase in perceived effort behind the feedback under an unpacked format. Using a multi-method approach, this research provides insights into the motivation for UGC and offers actionable managerial implications in designing effective strategy for platforms to display feedback and elicit more engaged content generation.

“Ride the Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising.” with Xiaobei Shen, Xiabing Zheng

This study investigates the spillover effect of online shopping festivals (hosted by e-commerce platforms) on viewers' reactions to short-video advertising (on media platforms) using a natural experiment. As e-commerce shopping festivals are now spanning longer periods, coupled with firms having the ability to customize the release time of short-video ads on media platforms, it is valuable to explore how the spillover effect changes over time. We do find the existence of the spillover effect. During the warm-up and general-promotion periods of the shopping festival, the spillover effect is positive, resulting in increased click-through rates of ads. However, during the peak-promotion and post-promotion periods, the spillover effect becomes negative. We explain the spillover effect as a joint result of the stimulating effect of the festival's environmental cues and the inhibiting effect of financial constraints on consumers. The proposed theoretical mechanisms are verified through a field experiment and a post-hoc analysis. As firms can tailor the time to release their ads, they may ride the wave of exogenous e-commerce shopping festivals, but shall carefully choose the best timing for their advertising on media platforms.